

Craig Hawkes

Curriculum Vitae · Lead Developer & Design Systems Architect

I build the system, the product that sits on top of it, and the gates that hold both to whatever I claimed. Eight years running my own studio, and a payment platform migrated without it going down.

Fifteen years across development and design, and it's the code that came first. I work in React, Next.js, TypeScript and .NET. I've built a 117-component enterprise design system on my own and gated its accessibility claim with tests rather than asserting it in a README, then delivered live Fiserv payment infrastructure on a PCI-DSS estate with mobile payments up 80% from launch. Six years as a qualified print and digital designer sits in the middle, trained separately. Nothing on this page is an assertion.

Open to lead, principal, head of engineering or first technical leader roles, contract or permanent.

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Five people in my family and I'm the only one who isn't dyslexic. Mum, dad, both my sisters. That's why I check the contrast rather than claim it.

02 · EXPERIENCE

BPO Collections Ltd Full Stack Developer Sept 2025 - Apr 2026 · Contract

Rebuilt the payment flow on Fiserv and led the platform's migration off legacy ASP.NET onto typed Next.js, with the estate trading throughout.

80% more mobile payments since launch

- 70% of that increase came through Apple Pay, across both single and continuous payments, on a Fiserv integration built end to end.
- Reduced a four-screen payment flow to one interaction with no loss of compliance coverage, worth roughly £500,000 a month more through the platform.
- Migrated off ASP.NET with a PCI-DSS estate of 97+ stored procedures live throughout. The platform never came down.
- Planned and ran the production cutover: three runbooks split by server to enforce ordering, and a backout procedure written before deployment rather than during it.

Next.js · TypeScript · ASP.NET · SQL Server · Fiserv

inclusive.io Co-founder & Design Systems Engineer Feb 2024 - Present · Part Time / Co-Founder

An enterprise design system and the applicant tracking product built on top of it, delivered single-handedly, with the accessibility claim enforced by gates rather than asserted in a document.

117 components · 26 ATS workflows · 0 axe violations · Solo build

- Every component ships with a unit test, a Storybook story and a documentation page, and all of it was delivered solo across two full rebuilds.
- Took a WCAG 2.2 AAA claim from an assertion to a register: 4 criteria enforced by test, 13 met, 3 exceptions published, 0 outstanding. 0 axe violations across 174 routes.
- Ran the build to a documented seven-phase framework, and produced 47 supporting documents. 18 research papers, 3 audit reports and a 14-document handover pack.
- Built with agent tooling throughout, held to the same gates as any other contributor. Rules and MCP servers live in the repo, and nothing merges unread.

React · Next.js · TypeScript · Tailwind · HeroUI · React Aria · Turborepo

DesignBuddy UK Founder & Full-Stack Developer Oct 2017 - Present · Business

Founded and still run an independent studio, taking clients from the first conversation through to deployment and the support that follows it.

8+ years · 50+ clients

- Build and ship production front ends in React, Next.js and Tailwind, plus custom WordPress themes, Shopify storefronts and PHP back ends.
- Take clients from first conversation through to deployment and post-launch support, rather than handing off at the design file.

React · Next.js · TypeScript · Tailwind · Shopify · WordPress · PHP

Paul McFadden Wealth Head of Web Dec 2022 - Jan 2024 · Full Time

Ran the web department for a property education group and the partner businesses selling alongside it, with every funnel, course platform and event page in the group coming through the team.

- Personally accountable for over £10m of revenue generated through the direct web funnels and event pages the department ran.

- Hired three of the team and co-managed the seven: five videographers, a junior web designer and a social media intern.
- Built four course-launch platforms end to end in WordPress and custom PHP, including ClickFunnels and Klaviyo integration.
- Shipped full-stack to WCAG accessibility standards, and rebuilt the campaign infrastructure: open rates up 60%, cold-outreach replies up 27%.

WordPress · PHP · JavaScript · HTML/CSS · Klaviyo · ClickFunnels

EARLIER

TMD Media Senior Web Designer Aug - Dec 2022

Built conversion-focused sites and marketing systems across an agency client portfolio, three or four concurrently, to fixed deadlines.

- Developed custom WordPress themes and plugins in PHP, moving clients off template-builder setups onto purpose-built front ends.

NOVAVAPES Graphic Designer Oct 2016 - Sept 2022

Sole designer for six years as the company scaled from startup to established brand, owning every surface from packaging to the e-commerce storefront.

- Designed and maintained the e-commerce storefront and product catalogues alongside the full brand system.
- Recruited and developed an apprentice from junior to running the social channel outright.

03 · SELECTED WORK

inclusive.io Design System

V1 core on npm as @hawkbass/inclusive-design-core under MIT, with exports, types and client directives checked against the built tarballs.

Quoin: a baseline grid engine for the web

Fits a design to a baseline grid before the CSS is written, and corrects a page that has already rendered when there is one. Public, MIT, no dependencies. Benchmarked against nine design systems including my own, which came last and was published that way.

04 · CAPABILITIES

ENGINEERING

- Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind
- Fiserv, Open Banking, PCI-DSS
- ASP.NET modernisation

RELEASE & PLATFORM

- Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD gates
- Vercel, preview and production
- Cutover and rollback runbooks

DESIGN SYSTEMS

- W3C DTCG token architecture
- OKLCH colour and component APIs
- ATS domain workflows

RESEARCH & DOCUMENTATION

- Seven-phase design system framework
- Specification and handover packs
- Standards read first-hand, not second

ACCESSIBILITY

- WCAG 2.2 AA gated, AAA where achievable
- React Aria interaction patterns
- axe-core and Playwright verification

DELIVERY

- DesignBuddy: 50+ clients, 8+ years
- Brand, web, and product builds
- Discovery through launch

05 · SKILLS

FRONTEND CORE

React · Next.js · TypeScript

DESIGN SYSTEMS

Design Tokens (W3C DTCG) · OKLCH Colour · Atomic Design

BACKEND & INFRASTRUCTURE

Node.js · ASP.NET (VB.NET & C#) · SQL Server / T-SQL

RESEARCH & DOCUMENTATION

Technical documentation · Design system specification · Competitive and standards research

AI & AGENT SYSTEMS

LLM providers (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google) · Prompt & context design · MCP servers

FRAMEWORKS & LIBRARIES

Angular · React Aria / React Stately · Radix UI

RELEASE, CI/CD & PLATFORM

Git · GitHub / GitHub Actions · CI/CD pipelines

TESTING & ACCESSIBILITY

WCAG 2.2 (AA gated, AAA where it holds) · axe-core / jest-axe · Playwright

DESIGN & CREATIVE

UI/UX Design · Adobe Creative Suite · Brand Identity